

Statement of Claim: Defective CPU

AMD EPYC 9B14 Processor — Return / Refund Request

Date: October 1, 2026

Summary

The AMD EPYC 9B14 processor purchased for this server has produced a consistent, repeatable hardware fault across three separate motherboards. The fault is a corrected PCIe bus error (SERR/PERR) that occurs at every system boot and localizes to the processor's own internal PCIe root complex, not to any motherboard component. Two independent motherboard replacements have been performed in an effort to resolve the issue; the fault persisted through both replacements. The processor is the only component common to all three builds. A replacement processor has been purchased independently to confirm this diagnosis by direct substitution, and the outcome of that test will be provided as supplemental evidence.

Basis for the Claim

- The identical fault signature has occurred on three independent motherboards (an initial board, a TYAN S8056GME replacement, and a second replacement board), ruling out a motherboard-specific cause.
- On the second board, every logged error localized to PCIe functions 00:01.4 and 00:01.5 — two sibling interfaces of the same internal processor PCIe controller ("root complex"), rather than to independent, unrelated device slots.
- On the current board, the primary NVMe storage device (rated for a 4-lane PCIe 5.0 connection) is negotiating only a 2-lane link at startup. On this motherboard class, the primary NVMe slot connects directly to the processor's own PCIe controller rather than through the motherboard chipset, which places the degraded connection on the processor side of the link, not the drive side.
- The error pattern (approximately 14 corrected PCI bus errors within the same second) has recurred identically at every cold boot across all three independent motherboards and their independent management controllers.

Ruled Out

- The NVMe storage drive: SMART health data is reported as fully healthy, with no media or data-integrity errors logged by the drive at any point. The one error event captured in detail was classified as a transport/communication error, not a data error, confirming the drive itself never reported corrupted or lost data.
- The motherboard: the fault survived two independent board replacements without change.
- Power supply or electrical grounding: tested and does not account for the fault being confined to one specific internal processor interface rather than spreading across unrelated components.
- Operating temperature: the fault has never occurred during the system's highest documented thermal load; all occurrences have been under idle or light-load, cooler conditions.
- Software or workload cause: one unrelated incident was separately identified as a software memory-management issue and corrected; it is excluded from this claim.

Timeline

Date	Event
Prior to Sep 12	Fault first observed on the original motherboard.
Sep 12–20	Fault recurs on first replacement motherboard; error localized to the processor's PCIe root complex.
Sep 25	Second motherboard replacement performed, with the processor re-seated per manufacturer torque specification.
Oct 1, 08:03	Fault recurs on the second replacement board: 14 corrected PCI bus errors logged at boot, matching the prior signature exactly.
Oct 1, 11:22	Primary NVMe drive confirmed negotiating a degraded link width versus its rated specification.

Supporting Evidence Available

- Server management-controller event logs (independent of the operating system) showing the identical error burst at boot on each of the three motherboards.
- Operating-system kernel logs showing the specific error codes and the exact processor PCIe interface each error was reported against.
- Diagnostic output showing the NVMe drive's rated versus actual (degraded) link width.
- Drive health (SMART) reports showing no media or data errors at any point.
- Photographs of processor installation/seating at each of the three builds.

Requested Resolution

A full refund or replacement of the AMD EPYC 9B14 processor is requested on the basis that it is defective. The processor is being retained, uninstalled, pending resolution of this claim, and remains available for inspection or return upon request.

This statement summarizes the technical findings from an ongoing hardware investigation. Detailed logs and raw diagnostic captures are available on request.